



To the Honorable Council
City of Norfolk, Virginia

November 18, 2025

From: Robert J Tajan
Planning Director

Subject: Zoning Text Amendment - City
Planning Commission

Reviewed:

Douglas Beaver, Deputy City
Manager

Ward/Superward:

Approved:

Patrick Roberts, City Manager

Item Number:

- I. **Planning Commission Recommendation:** By a vote of **6 to 0**, the Planning Commission recommended **approval** of the text amendment.

II. **Summary of Request**

To amend the Zoning Ordinance to require a Conditional Use Permit for Self-Service Storage Units throughout the City.

Self-Service Storage Units are permitted by-right in C-C (Community-Commercial), C-R (Regional-Commercial), BC-O (Business Commerce-Office), BC-I (Business Commerce-Industrial), I-L (Light Industrial) and by CUP in TOD-S (Transit-Oriented Development Support), and G-1 (Granby/Monticello Corridor Mixed Use).

This request would change the by-right designations to require a CUP.

III. **Plan Consistency**

The “Enhancing Economic Vitality” chapter of *plaNorfolk2030* includes a goal for enhancing economic health and increasing employment opportunities through business retention and expansion and business attraction.

- Outcome EV1.1 aims to foster an enhanced environment and resources to support business expansion and investment.

- Since the proposed text amendment is intended to ensure this outcome can continue to be met, the proposal is consistent with *plaNorfolk2030*.

IV. Zoning Analysis

The use first appeared in the 1992 *Zoning Ordinance*, which defined then as Mini Warehouse.

- Mini Warehouse was permitted by right in BC-1 & BC-2 (Business and Commerce Park), C-2 (Corridor Commercial), C-4 (Large Scale Commercial), I-1 (Limited Industrial), I-2 (Light Industrial), and PD-MU 1st Bay (1st Bay Planned Development District), and was allowed by Special Exception in TOD-S (Transit-Oriented Development-Support) and C-3 (Retail Center).
 - The name of the use was changed to Self-Service Storage Units in the 2018 *Zoning Ordinance*.
 - The *Zoning Ordinance* defines Self-Service Storage Units as a building or group of buildings divided into separate self-contained units or areas of 1,000 square feet or less that are offered for rent for self-service storage of household and personal property. The storage units or areas are designed to allow private access by the tenant for storing and removing personal property. Accessory uses may include leasing offices, outdoor storage of boats and recreational vehicles, incidental sales or rental of moving supplies and equipment, and living quarters for a resident manager or security guard. The rental of trucks or trailers is a separate principal use and not considered accessory to this use.
 - Applicable performance standards for the use include:
 - All doors directly accessing individual storage units shall not be located so as to be directly visible from any public right-of-way.
 - Chain-link or other types of wire fencing shall not be utilized on site.
- The use is currently permitted by-right in C-C (Community-Commercial), C-R (Regional-Commercial), BC-O (Business Commerce-Office), BC-I (Business Commerce-Industrial), I-L (Light Industrial) and by CUP in TOD-S (Transit-Oriented Development Support), and G-1 (Granby/Monticello Corridor Mixed Use).

V. Communication Outreach/Notification

Legal notification was placed in *The Virginian-Pilot* on September 11 and September 18.

VI. Recommendation

Staff recommends that the Zoning Text Amendment request be **approved**.

Proponents

None

Opponents

None

Supporting Material:

Ordinance Exhibits (A-B) (PDF)

Proposed Text (PDF)



City Planning Commission Public Hearing: September 25, 2025

Executive Secretary: Robert Tajan, AICP

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Robert Tajan".

Staff Planner: Andrew Adams

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Andrew Adams".

Staff Report		Item No
Staff Report	Item No.	
Applicant	City Planning Commission	
Request	Zoning Text Amendment	Amend the <i>Zoning Ordinance</i> to require Self-Service Storage Units by Conditional Use Permit (CUP) in all districts where it is currently permitted by right.

A. Summary of Request

Self-Service Storage Units are permitted by-right in C-C (Community-Commercial), C-R (Regional-Commercial), BC-O (Business Commerce-Office), BC-I (Business Commerce-Industrial), I-L (Light Industrial) and by CUP in TOD-S (Transit-Oriented Development Support), and G-1 (Granby/Monticello Corridor Mixed Use).

This request would change the by-right designations to require a CUP.

B. Plan Consistency

The “Enhancing Economic Vitality” chapter of *plaNorfolk2030* includes a goal for enhancing economic health and increasing employment opportunities through business retention and expansion and business attraction.

- Outcome EV1.1 aims to foster an enhanced environment and resources to support business expansion and investment.
- Since the proposed text amendment is intended to ensure this outcome can continue to be met, the proposal is consistent with *plaNorfolk2030*.

C. Analysis

The use first appeared in the 1992 *Zoning Ordinance*, which defined then as Mini Warehouse.

- Mini Warehouse was permitted by right in BC-1 & BC-2 (Business and Commerce Park), C-2 (Corridor Commercial), C-4 (Large Scale Commercial), I-1 (Limited Industrial), I-2 (Light Industrial), and PD-MU 1st Bay (1st Bay Planned Development District), and was allowed by Special Exception in TOD-S (Transit-Oriented Development-Support) and C-3 (Retail Center).

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The use is currently permitted by-right in C-C (Community-Commercial), C-R (Regional-Commercial), BC-O (Business Commerce-Office), BC-I (Business Commerce-Industrial), I-L (Light Industrial) and by CUP in TOD-S (Transit-Oriented Development Support), and G-1 (Granby/Monticello Corridor Mixed Use).

D. Communication Outreach/Notification

Legal notification was placed in *The Virginian-Pilot* on September 11 and September 18.

E. Recommendation

Planning Staff and Economic Development have voiced concerns over the potential impacts over the concentration and proliferation of Self-Service Storage Units throughout the City.

Self-Service Storage Units provide a necessary service, especially with the transient nature of many residents due to the Navy. However, the use is inefficient on certain sites.

- The use requires large amounts of land but has low job creation and limited economic benefit.

The G-1 and TOD-S zoning districts both allow Self-Service Storage Units by CUP. Requiring a CUP in all zoning districts where the use is currently allowed by-right would allow for a site-specific analysis and discretion on sites where the use is not the most appropriate.

Staff supports the *Zoning Ordinance* Text Amendment requiring a CUP for Self-Service Storage Units in zoning districts where it is currently permitted by-right.

The CUP process would allow for a site-specific analysis and identification of potential negative impacts to the use's high land consumption coupled with limited economic benefit and low employment creation.

Supporting Material:

Ordinance Exhibits (A-B) (PDF)

Proposed Text (PDF)



By: _____
Office of the City Attorney



By: _____
DEPT. Planning

NORFOLK, VIRGINIA

Ordinance No. 50174

AN ORDINANCE TO AMEND TABLES 3.3.9 AND 3.5.7 OF THE
NORFOLK ZONING ORDINANCE SO AS TO PERMIT THE USE OF
"SELF-SERVICE STORAGE UNITS" BY CONDITIONAL USE PERMIT
ONLY.

- - -

BE IT ORDAINED by the Council of the City of Norfolk:

Section 1:- That Table 3.3.9 of the Norfolk Zoning Ordinance,
entitled "Principal, Accessory, and Temporary Use Table for
Commercial Base Zoning Districts," is hereby amended and
reordained so as to allow "Self-service storage units" as an
principal use by conditional use permit only in C-C (Community
Commercial), C-R (Regional Commercial), BC-O (Business and
Commerce Park - Office), and BC-I (Business and Commerce Park -
Industrial) zoning districts. The table shall read as set forth
in "Exhibit A," attached hereto.

Section 2:- That Table 3.5.7 of the Norfolk Zoning Ordinance,
entitled "Principal, Accessory, and Temporary Use Table for
Industrial Base Zoning Districts," is hereby amended and
reordained so as to allow "Self-service storage units" as an
principal use by conditional use permit only in I-L (Industrial -
Light) zoning district. The table shall read as set forth in
"Exhibit B," attached hereto.

Section 3:- The Council hereby finds that this zoning
amendment is required by public necessity, convenience, general
welfare, or good zoning practice.

Section 4:- That this ordinance shall be in effect from the
date of its adoption.

EXHIBITS:

Exhibit A - Text of Amended Table 3.3.9 (1 page)

Exhibit B - Text of Amended Section 3.5.7 (1 page)

Adopted by Council November 18, 2025
Effective November 18, 2025

TRUE COPY
TESTE:

RICHARD ALLAN BULL

BY:

CHIEF DEPUTY CITY CLERK

ARTICLE 3: ZONING DISTRICTS

3.3 COMMERCIAL BASE ZONING DISTRICTS

3.3.9. USES FOR THE COMMERCIAL BASE ZONING DISTRICTS

TABLE 3.3.9: PRINCIPAL, ACCESSORY, AND TEMPORARY USE TABLE FOR COMMERCIAL BASE ZONING DISTRICTS

**P = PERMITTED BY RIGHT C = ALLOWED ONLY WITH APPROVAL OF A CONDITIONAL USE PERMIT
BLANK CELL = PROHIBITED**

USE CATEGORY	USE TYPE	C-Z	C-C	C-R	O	BC-O	BC-I	PERFORMANCE STANDARDS
CONSERVATION AND OPEN SPACE USES								
Retail Sales and Service Uses	Animal shelter						P	4.2.3.F(6)(a)
	Artisanal production		P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(b)
	Artist studio/school/gallery	P	P	P		P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(c)
	Auction house		P	P			P	4.2.3.F(6)(d)
	Auto supply sales and rental		P/C	P/C				4.2.3.F(6)(e)
	Bank or other financial institution	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(f)
	Cannabis dispensing facility		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(g)
	Check cashing, auto title, or payday loan businesses		C					4.2.3.F(6)(h)
	Consignment shop	P	P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(i)
	Convenience store	C	C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(j)
	Establishment for the sale of distilled spirits for off-premises consumption		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(k)
	Farmer's market	P	P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(l)
	Flea market, indoor		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(m)
	Flea market, outdoor		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(n)
	Funeral home or mortuary		P					4.2.3.F(6)(o)
	Grocery store	C	P/C	P/C				4.2.3.F(6)(p)
	Kennel		C	C			C	4.2.3.F(6)(q)
	Music, dance, or martial arts studio/school	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(r)
	Novelty store or theater, adult		C					4.2.3.F(6)(s)
	Office	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(t)
	Office, contractor	P	P	P		P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(u)
	Office, medical or dental	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(v)
	Pawnshop		C					4.2.3.F(6)(w)
	Personal service business	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C		4.2.3.F(6)(x)

4.2.3.F(5)

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USE CATEGORY	USE TYPE	C-N	C-C	C-R	O	BC-O	BC-I	PERFORMANCE STANDARDS
	Retail goods establishment	P/C	P/C	P/C				4.2.3.F(6)(y)
	Self-service storage units		P/C	P/C		P/C	P/C	4.2.3.F(6)(z)
	Smoke or vape shop	C	C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(aa)
	Tattoo parlor		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(bb)
	Therapeutic massage facility		P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(cc)
	Used books/media	P	P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(dd)
	Used merchandise sales	C	C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(ee)
	Vendor park, food	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	4.2.3.F(6)(ff)
	Veterinary hospital or clinic		P	P	P		P	4.2.3.F(6)(gg)

ARTICLE 3: ZONING DISTRICTS

3.5 INDUSTRIAL BASE ZONING DISTRICTS

3.5.7. USES FOR THE INDUSTRIAL BASE ZONING DISTRICTS

TABLE 3.5.7: PRINCIPAL, ACCESSORY, AND TEMPORARY USE TABLE FOR INDUSTRIAL BASE ZONING DISTRICTS						
- P = PERMITTED BY RIGHT - C = ALLOWED ONLY WITH APPROVAL OF A CONDITIONAL USE PERMIT - BLANK CELL = PROHIBITED						
USE CATEGORY	USE TYPE	I-L	I-G	I-W	I-DW	PERFORMANCE STANDARDS
CONSERVATION AND OPEN SPACE USES						
Retail Sales and Service Uses	Animal shelter	P				4.2.3.F(6)(a)
	Artist studio/school/gallery	P	P			4.2.3.F(6)(c)
	Auction house	P	P			4.2.3.F(6)(d)
	Bank or other financial institution	P				4.2.3.F(6)(f)
	Convenience store	C	C			4.2.3.F(6)(j)
	Kennel	P	P			4.2.3.F(6)(q)
	Music, dance, or martial arts studio/school	P				4.2.3.F(6)(r)
	Office	P	P			4.2.3.F(6)(t)
	Office, contractor	P	P			4.2.3.F(6)(u)
	Self-service storage units	<u>P</u> C				4.2.3.F(6)(z)
	Tattoo parlor	C				4.2.3.F(6)(bb)
	Vendor park, food	P/C	P/C			4.2.3.F(6)(ff)
	Veterinary hospital or clinic	P				4.2.3.F(6)(gg)
	All other uses, not permitted					

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Retail Sales and Service Uses	CONSERVATION AND OPEN SPACE USES							
	Animal shelter						P	4.2.3.F(6)(a)
	Artisanal production		P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(b)
	Artist studio/school/gallery	P	P	P		P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(c)
	Auction house		P	P			P	4.2.3.F(6)(d)
	Auto supply sales and rental		P/C	P/C				4.2.3.F(6)(e)
	Bank or other financial institution	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(f)
	Cannabis dispensing facility		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(g)
	Check cashing, auto title, or payday loan businesses		C					4.2.3.F(6)(h)
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	Establishment for the sale of distilled spirits for off-premises consumption		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(k)
	Farmer's market	P	P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(l)
	Flea market, indoor		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(m)
	Flea market, outdoor		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(n)
	Funeral home or mortuary		P					4.2.3.F(6)(o)
	Grocery store	C	P/C	P/C				4.2.3.F(6)(p)
	Kennel		C	C			C	4.2.3.F(6)(q)
	Music, dance, or martial arts studio/school	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(r)
	Novelty store or theater, adult		C					4.2.3.F(6)(s)
	Office	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(t)
	Office, contractor	P	P	P		P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(u)
	Office, medical or dental	P	P	P	P	P	P	4.2.3.F(6)(v)
	Pawnshop		C					4.2.3.F(6)(w)
	Personal service business	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C		4.2.3.F(6)(x)

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	Self-service storage units		P/C	P/C		P/C	P/C	4.2.3.F(6)(z)	
	Smoke or vape shop	C	C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(aa)	
	Tattoo parlor		C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(bb)	
	Therapeutic massage facility		P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(cc)	
	Used books/media	P	P	P				4.2.3.F(6)(dd)	
	Used merchandise sales	C	C	C				4.2.3.F(6)(ee)	
	Vendor park, food	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	P/C	4.2.3.F(6)(ff)	
	Veterinary hospital or clinic		P	P	P		P	4.2.3.F(6)(gg)	

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	Bank or other financial institution	P				4.2.3.F(6)(f)
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	Music, dance, or martial arts studio/school	P				4.2.3.F(6)(r)
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	Vendor park, food	P/C	P/C			4.2.3.F(6)(ff)
	Veterinary hospital or clinic	P				4.2.3.F(6)(gg)
	All other uses, not permitted					